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As tariff uncertainty rises, stocks tumble

China, Ontario levy retaliatory measures amid talk of possible recession this year

By Danielle Kaye and Eshe Nelson
NEW YORK TIMES

A volatile Wall Street suffered its steepest decline of the year on Monday, a drop fueled by angst about the economy a day after President Trump refused to rule out the possibility that his policies could trigger a recession.

The S&P 500 slid 2.7 percent, the worst daily fall in an already three-week-long stretch of selling.

The index is now roughly 9 percent below a record set last month and approaching a “correction,” a Wall Street term for a decline of 10 percent or more from a recent high.

Over the past few weeks, Trump has threatened, imposed, suspended, and resumed tariffs on America’s largest trade partners: Canada, Mexico, and China. The dizzying shifts, including last-minute exemptions for some automakers and energy products, have unnerved in-

vestors.

“The market volatility is much less about the bad news of tariffs and much more about the uncertainty of tariffs, especially uncertainty as to what the policy is, where it is headed, how long it will last, and what the end result will be,” said David Bahnsen, the chief investment officer at the Bahnsen Group.

In a Fox News interview that aired Sunday, Trump was asked about “rising worries about a slowdown,” by host Maria Bartiro-

7.1%

How far the S&P stock index has fallen since Feb. 1, when the president announced 25% tariffs, mostly since rescinded, on Mexico and Canada.

mo. He described what might follow as “a period of transition,” and didn’t rule out the possibility that his policies would cause a recession. Asked during the interview when businesses might have clarity on the on-again, off-again tariff policies, Trump responded by suggesting that more tariffs could come.

“We may go up with some tariffs. It depends. We may go up. I don’t think we’ll go down, or we may go up,” he said.

TARIFFS, Page A6

Campuses anxious amid US pressure

Harvard joins MIT in new hiring freeze as Trump widens threats to cut funds

By Mike Damiano, Hilary Burns, and Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

Harvard University and the Massachusetts Institute of Technology froze new hiring, and students and administrators at schools across New England were left slack-jawed after the Trump administration took extraordinary measures to widen its crackdown on universities during a frenetic four-day blitz.

The government yanked \$400 million of funding from Columbia University on Friday over alleged inaction on antisemitism. Over the weekend, immigration agents arrested a Palestinian student activist at the New York university and whisked him to a detention facility in Louisiana. Then, on Monday, the Department of Education put 60 colleges and universities on notice that they could face sanctions if they do not comply with the administration’s reading of federal civil rights laws.

Administration officials warned that these actions were just the beginning. More cuts are on the way, they said, and the president posted on Truth Social Monday that the detention of the Palestinian graduate at Columbia was “the first arrest of many to come.”

HARVARD, Page A5

Fishermen adrift after NOAA layoffs

Cuts, confusion on rules imperil start of key season

By Sabrina Shankman
GLOBE STAFF

Each year come May 1, more than 100 commercial fishing boats in ports across New England gear up and head out into the still-frigid waters.

Their mission: haul in millions of pounds of groundfish, the group of species that New Englanders have been eating for centuries — haddock, hake, pollock, cod, and more.

This year, it’s not clear when that will happen, which means restaurants and grocery stores may not have a local supply of the fish to sell. At least two of the federal employees who make this delicate dance hum along, overseeing regulations and coordinating with fishermen, were given the pink slip.

Sarah Cierpich spent 19 years working with the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration, though she had been a contract worker until last September. That switch made her a probationary employee and thus subject to the sweeping layoffs that have hit federal agencies.

She was at home sick when her boss called. “I hate to tell you this, but can you check your email?”

NOAA, Page A5



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

During the COVID-19 lockdown, Karin Ganga Sheppard in Nantucket took care of her 94-year-old mother and her husband, who broke his ankle. New research shows the lockdown, which left Boston streets empty (below), did significant harm.

The lowdown on lockdowns

Some studies show they can harm personal well-being, students, and the economy, prompting a rethinking of governments’ tactics in pandemic

By Chris Serres
GLOBE STAFF

Sumbul Siddiqui remembers every detail about the morning of March 10, 2020. She remembers feeling anxious as she walked into a Somerville conference room packed with masked-up mayors from around Boston. She remembers grim-looking doctors from Italy on a big screen, describing the horrors of people collapsing and dying from a mysterious respiratory illness.

After that, Siddiqui, then mayor of Cambridge, did what she never imagined she would have to do: She called top city administrators and the school superintendent to begin

the process of shutting down every school and municipal building in the state’s fourth-largest city.

“We all left that meeting terrified,” she said. “I remember saying, ‘OK, we have to shut things down. We have to stop the spread. I don’t want people to die.’”

Five years later, Siddiqui is still torn about the decision. On that same day, Governor Charlie Baker declared a state of emergency in Massachusetts and, within days, suspended in-person learning at public and private schools and banned on-site dining at bars and restaurants across the state.

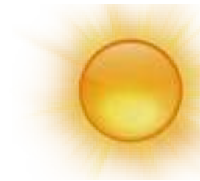
SHUTDOWN, Page A7



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

FIVE YEARS LATER

Lessons for the next pandemic



The winter aaahs

Tuesday: Tons of sun, breezy. High 55-60, low 36-41.

Wednesday: Cool, flurries late. High 50-55, low 31-36.

Sunrise: 7:03. Sunset: 6:56.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C10.**

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JAMIE SQUIRE/GETTY IMAGES/FILE

GOING ON OFFENSIVE OVER DEFENSE

The New England Patriots made a \$200 million downpayment on rebuilding the team’s fortunes, with free agent deals for star defensive tackle Milton Williams (above), cornerback Carlton Davis, and linebacker Robert Spillane. **C1.**

Another round of the largest layoffs in Mass General Brigham’s history hit workers, part of a consolidation of MGH and Brigham and Women’s. **D1.**

Prominent developer Thomas O’Brien is considering a bid to oust Mayor Michelle Wu. **B1.**

When it comes to boycott of chains, action often cannot match intent

Liberal shoppers struggle to link wallet, politics as retailers embrace conservative causes

By Dana Gerber
GLOBE STAFF

EVERETT — Eli Mazelsky wishes he didn’t have to shop at Target. And yet, on a recent Thursday afternoon, there he was, spending \$45 on cleaning supplies including dish soap, toilet cleaner, and Clorox wipes.

Mazelsky, a transgender man, is disheartened by the retailer’s scrapping of some of its diversity, equity, and inclusion policies, as well as its rollback of some LGBTQ+ merchandise in advance of Pride Month last year. But Mazelsky, who is disabled and uses a wheelchair, depends on Uber to get around, so going to multiple stores for necessities isn’t feasible. For all his

SHOPPING, Page A4



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Driver Mario Pierre-Louis watched Eli Mazelsky board an Uber at Target in Everett last week. Mazelsky still shops there because of the variety and convenience.

